Katie Boulter Wins After a Rain Delay in Japan

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British **tennis** player Katie Boulter won her first match at the Japan Open in Osaka. But she had to wait until the next day to finish it.

Boulter played Himeno Sakatsume, a Japanese player the home crowd cheered for. On Monday, Boulter won the first **set** and was ahead 3-1 in the second **set**. Then rain stopped the match.

On Tuesday, the players came back. Boulter won 6-3, 6-1.

"Yesterday was a tough spot to end at," Boulter said. She said she had to keep the same **focus** the next day to finish the match. She was happy she did not have to play a third **set**.

Boulter, who is 30, will play Viktorija Golubic of Switzerland next.

In other **tennis** news, star player Iga Swiatek left a different **tournament** because of a thigh **injury**. That could make it harder for her to reach the WTA Finals in November.

Word Treasure

tennis -- A sport where players hit a ball over a net with rackets.
set -- A part of a tennis match made up of several games.
focus -- Paying close attention to one thing without getting distracted.
tournament -- A competition with many players and several rounds.
injury -- Harm to the body, such as a hurt muscle.

Background you need

A tennis match is split into sets, and the player who wins enough sets wins the match.

Outdoor matches stop when it rains because a wet court is slippery.

When play stops, players finish later from the same score.

Break it down

WHO: British player Katie Boulter and Japanese player Himeno Sakatsume
WHAT: Boulter won her first match 6-3, 6-1
WHERE: The Japan Open in Osaka, Japan
WHY: Rain stopped the match, so they finished it the next day

Why it matters

Boulter shows that staying focused after a break can help you finish what you started, whether in sports or schoolwork.

Test what you remember

1. Where was the Japan Open match played?

(A) Osaka
(B) London
(C) Paris
(D) New York

2. Why did the match stop on Monday?

(A) Snow
(B) A power outage
(C) Rain
(D) A fire drill

3. What was the score when Boulter won?

(A) 6-3, 6-1
(B) 7-6, 7-6
(C) 6-0, 6-0
(D) 3-6, 1-6

4. How old is Katie Boulter?

(A) 40
(B) 20
(C) 25
(D) 30

5. Who will Boulter play next?

(A) Mimi Xu
(B) Iga Swiatek
(C) Viktorija Golubic
(D) Himeno Sakatsume

6. Why did Iga Swiatek leave a tournament?

(A) She got lost
(B) She lost her racket
(C) A thigh injury
(D) She was tired of rain

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: A 4: D 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Katie Boulter: Said stopping on Monday was tough, and she was happy she did not have to play a third set.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):